> "We chose Postgres Plus to solve our pain areas, namely, scalability and support issues. Postgres Plus was one-tenth the cost of other RDBMS. Further, we have seen huge cost reductions in our IT costs thereafter."
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> **—Mohit Saxena, VP (technology), InMobi Global Media Adnetwork**

databases, Postgres Plus' replication capabilities can provide real-time data warehousing at a fraction of the cost of Oracle's replication solutions. This eliminates OLTP performance problems while ensuring timely delivery of critical information to business stakeholders," says Mehra. For example, FTD, the worldwide leader in floral-related products and services, implemented the Postgres Plus Advanced Server Replication Server module to improve performance of their production systems while still meeting the needs of their vendor network. "By moving their vendor-facing order tracking system away from their Oracle-based production environment and onto replicated systems running on Postgres Plus Advanced Server, the performance of their production systems increased more than 400 per cent during the next peak ordering season – all while reducing the cost of operating this system by more than 80 per cent," says Mehra.

Rich features

The fundamental features of Postgres Plus Standard Server and Advanced Server distinguish them from their primary open source competitors, like MySQL and Ingres. "PostgreSQL contains a single unified storage engine capable of performing extremely fast for all load types: OLTP (with full ACID support), reporting and mixed usage. MySQL, on the other hand, has pluggable storage engines specialised for particular types of usage; this type of configuration can result in bottlenecks as applications grow and change. Subqueries, too, are poorly optimised in MySQL. Further, user defined data types in Postgres Plus give users more options for customised solutions than MySQL, also building room for database enforced encryption," says Mehra.

The Oracle compatibility features found in Postgres Plus Advanced Server distinguish it from its distant cousin Ingres, another strong open source database competitor. "EnterpriseDB has added powerful and convenient Oracle features to Postgres Plus Advanced Server that are standard fare in the minds of many DBAs and developers, such as: function packages, dynamic runtime instrumentation, query optimisation hints, Oracle SQL extensions, explicit transaction controls, and data dictionary views," says Mehra.

Further, Postgres Plus Standard Server and Postgres Plus Advanced Server come with many productivity tools like Postgres Studio (graphical tool for database and cluster creation/maintenance, SQL environment, and more), EDB SQL (SQL command line environment), EDB Loader (bulk data loader with error handling), DBA Management Server (for DBAs to handle monitoring, job scheduling, SQL terminal, software update management), DBA Monitoring Console (for resource usage and management), GRidSQL Monitoring Console for distributed data, and the Oracle Replication console.

Performance enhancer

EnterpriseDB's Postgres Plus products have multiple features across many facets of the database to help improve performance. While GridSQL partitions data across multiple machines and transparently performs queries, Asynchronous Pre-Fetch can optimise regular index scans and bitmap index scans by issuing concurrent I/O requests to RAID (Redundant Array of Inexpensive Disks) hardware on Linux systems. On the other hand, Multi-Version Concurrency Control (MVCC) allows for high performance in applications that are both read and write intensive.

The best example of performance enhancement using Postgres Plus is hi5, a leading social networking site that deployed OLTP PostgreSQL installations, running on hundreds of servers. "The system supports the data transactions of more than 56 million active users each month. In June 2008, the company delivered more than 18.5 billion page views that were supported by PostgreSQL, serving nearly 11 million visitors to the site every day," boasts Mehra of Postgres Plus.

NTT, too, saw better performance when they deployed Postgres Plus for transactional telecom business applications. "We deployed PostgreSQL for